

HOME SELLING • FAIRFIELD COUNTY, CT

How Long Does It Take to Sell a House in Fairfield County, CT?

Real timelines. Local insight. No guesswork.



By **Mark Pires**
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This is one of the first questions sellers ask me — and it's a reasonable one. You have a life to plan around. Maybe you're relocating, downsizing, or trying to time the purchase of your next home. The answer matters.

The honest answer is: it depends on three things — price, condition, and the market you're selling in. Let me give you the real numbers, both nationally and here in Fairfield County.

The National Picture in 2026

According to the National Association of Realtors (NAR) March 2026 Existing-Home Sales Report, the national median time on market is currently 41 days — meaning half of all homes sell faster than that, and half take longer.

That's up from 36 days in March 2025, reflecting a market where buyers are taking more time to make decisions.

Key 2026 National Stats (NAR, April 2026):

Median existing-home price: \$417,700 · Days on market: 41 (March 2026) · Inventory: 4.4 months supply · Year-over-year price increase: 34th consecutive month of gains

Once a home goes under contract, the closing process typically takes another 30–45 days depending on whether the buyer is financing (longer) or paying cash (shorter). So from the day you list to the day you hand over keys, plan on 6 to 12 weeks in a normal market.

Fairfield County Is Not a Normal Market

Fairfield County — particularly the towns of Westport, Greenwich, Darien, and New Canaan — consistently outperforms national averages. In our market, well-priced homes in good condition are routinely going under contract in 15 to 25 days, sometimes faster. I've had listings here receive multiple offers within 72 hours of going live.

Why? Because Fairfield County absorbs significant demand from buyers leaving New York City, and that demand doesn't stop when the national market softens. The Metro-North commuter corridor creates a persistent floor under prices in this county that you simply don't see everywhere else.

The Three Variables That Control Your Timeline

1. Pricing — the single biggest factor

Homes priced correctly from day one sell significantly faster and for more money than homes that start too high and reduce. This is not a theory — it's something I see in the data on every Comparative Market Analysis I run. Buyers notice how long a home has been on the market. When they see a price reduction, they wonder what's wrong with it, and they start lowballing. Getting the price right from the start is the most important decision you'll make.

2. Presentation — professional marketing moves the needle

According to NAR's 2025 Profile of Home Buyers and Sellers, 97% of buyers used the internet during their home search. Your first showing is online. Professional photography, video, and — where appropriate — aerial drone footage are no longer optional if you want to compete at the top of your price range. This is something I've been doing since before most agents owned a drone. It matters.

3. Market conditions — inventory and interest rates

Fairfield County currently sits at well below the 6-month inventory that defines a balanced market. When supply is tight and demand is persistent — which describes our market right now — sellers hold more leverage. That said, buyers in 2026 are more deliberate than they were in 2021–2022. They are comparing, they are inspecting, and they are not panic-buying. Respect that, price accordingly, and your home sells.

The Timeline, Broken Down

Pre-market prep (1–3 weeks): Photography, any minor repairs, staging decisions, CMA review, listing agreement

Active listing to accepted offer (15–40 days): In Fairfield County's current market, expect the better end of that range for well-priced homes

Accepted offer to closing (30–45 days): Attorney review, inspection, appraisal, mortgage commitment

Total: approximately **7–12 weeks** from the decision to sell to keys in the buyer's hands.

THE BIG PICTURE: 2026 MARKET TIMELINES



NATIONAL MEDIAN
TIME ON MARKET

41 DAYS

(March 2026 – NAR)



FAIRFIELD COUNTY
AVERAGE TIME ON MARKET

15–25 DAYS

Well-priced homes



TOTAL TIME FROM
LIST TO CLOSE

45–70 DAYS

Including closing process

The Fairfield County Reality

In towns like Westport, Darien, Greenwich, New Canaan, and Wilton, well-priced, well-presented homes are moving fast.

- ✓ **Hot homes:** 7–15 days
- ✓ **Strong homes:** 15–25 days
- ✓ **Average homes:** 25–40 days
- ✓ **Overpriced homes:** 40+ days (and sell for less)



TRUTH BOMB

Overpriced homes that sit and then reduce sell for less than homes priced right from the start. Always.

THE COMPLETE TIMELINE



1. PREP & LISTING (1–2 WEEKS)
Staging, photography, pricing, and marketing launch



2. UNDER CONTRACT (7–25 DAYS)
Marketing period until you accept the right offer



3. DUE DILIGENCE (10–14 DAYS)
Inspections, appraisal, and buyer review period



4. ATTORNEY REVIEW (1–2 WEEKS)
Contracts reviewed and finalized



5. CLOSING (30–45 DAYS)
Final walkthrough, funding, and closing day!

What Slows a Sale Down

In my experience, the things that extend timelines are almost always avoidable. Overpricing is the biggest one. Deferred maintenance that triggers inspection issues is second — buyers don't walk away from good homes, but they renegotiate hard when they find problems. Tenants in the property, estate situations that require court approvals, and unusual title issues can also add weeks.

"The sellers who close the fastest are the ones who made the hard decisions early — priced it right, addressed the obvious repairs, and let professionals do the marketing."

A Note on Cash vs. Financed Buyers

Cash buyers can close in as little as two weeks if they want to move quickly. In Fairfield County's luxury segment — homes above \$1.5 million — cash transactions are common. If your home attracts a cash buyer, your closing timeline compresses dramatically.

What Would Your Home Sell For — and How Fast?

I can give you a realistic timeline and pricing range for your specific home, neighborhood, and current market conditions. Free, no obligation, and I'll give you the honest answer even if it's not what you want to hear.

**GET YOUR FREE
HOME VALUATION**



PRO TIPS TO SELL FASTER



**Price it Right
From Day One**

The #1 factor that determines your timeline and result.



**Presentation
Matters**

Professional photos, video, and staging make a huge impact.



**List on
Thursday/Friday**

Capture weekend buyers when attention is highest.



**Market
Strategically**

Visibility + targeting = more showings and better offers.



ABOUT THE AUTHOR

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I'm Connecticut's one and only "House Detective." I use data, experience, and detective-level attention to detail to help my clients solve real estate.



**THE
HOUSE
DETECTIVE**

SOLVING REAL ESTATE. DELIVERING RESULTS.

📧 Have Questions About Selling Your Home? Let's Talk.

CONTACT MARK

Mark Pires is a Realtor with Coldwell Banker Realty in Fairfield CT with 20 years experience working with buyers and sellers in Fairfield County CT. the creator and host of Discover CT. a hyper local community based street interview and real estate advice show with weekly buyer and seller advice on all socials.

Mark is also CT's Original House Detective

(Marks Proprietary Cinema Noir Listing Experience) Every Listing is A New Case To Solve..

Call or Text Mark Pires if you need ANY assistance

or if you have another topic you'd like covered.

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